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Entrepreneurship Theory and Practice

1. Toward a Relational Perspective on Hybrid Entrepreneurship: Institutional Complexity and the Co-Construction of Liminal Space in Hybrid Female Entrepreneurship

Authors: Mulu Hundera, Mona Mensmann, Stefanie Habersang

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261453879](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261453879)

Published: 2026-06-19

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Female Entrepreneurship, International Business, Institutional Theory
- **Theories:** Institutional Complexity, Relational Perspective, Liminality, Social Embeddedness

Abstract:

This study examines hybrid entrepreneurship (HE) in non-Western contexts where informal and non-market institutions are central. Based on 31 case studies of female hybrid entrepreneurs in Ethiopia and 64 in-depth interviews, we conceptualize HE as a relational, co-constructed process shaped by institutional complexity. Women enact HE in liminal spaces sustained through relational practices: reconfiguring boundaries, cultivating ambiguity and gray areas, and maintaining webs of reciprocity. Institutional complexity both enables and constrains HE, underscoring its social embeddedness rather than individual agency. The study advances research on HE, female entrepreneurship, and institutional complexity by foregrounding relational dynamics and gendered experiences.

□ Hundera - Toward a Relational Perspective on Hybrid Entrepreneurship Institutional Complex.pdf

2. Resource Orchestration, Team Faultlines, and Entrepreneurial Resilience

Authors: Jian Guan, Shengyuan Lin, Justin Tan, Jiamin Dong

DOI: [10.1177/10422587261453883](https://doi.org/10.1177/10422587261453883)

Published: 2026-06-23

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Entrepreneurship, Organizational Behavior
- **Theories:** Resource Orchestration Theory, Team Faultlines, Entrepreneurial Resilience, Resource Slack

Abstract:

This study develops an integrated resource orchestration framework to examine how internal resource configurations shape entrepreneurial resilience in new ventures under crisis conditions. Specifically, we focus on bundles of social and technological resource slack and constraints and conceptualize entrepreneurial resilience as comprising two dimensions: stability (severity of loss) and flexibility (time to recovery). We argue that stability is primarily driven by a resource compensation logic, whereas flexibility is driven by a crisis-induced resource reconfiguration logic. Extending resource orchestration theory (ROT), we conceptualize entrepreneurial teams as the central actors of resource orchestration and introduce entrepreneurial team task-related faultlines (ETTF) as a key structural mechanism shaping how effectively resources are mobilized under disruption. Using a sample of 345 Chinese listed new ventures, we find that dual resource slack reduces severity of loss but slows recovery, whereas among constrained bundles, social resource slack combined with technological constraints enables both lower loss and faster recovery. Response surface analyses further show that greater misalignment between social and technological resources increases loss severity but shortens recovery time. In addition, ETTF moderates the effects of resource bundles on resilience outcomes by strengthening both compensatory coordination and reconfiguration capacity. This study advances ROT by showing that internal resource configurations shape entrepreneurial resilience through both bundle composition and misalignment, contingent on team structural conditions.

Strategic Entrepreneurship Journal

1. Co-explorers of the imaginary: How fictional framing legitimates radical novelty by connecting entrepreneurial imagination to stakeholder possibilistic thinking

Authors: Violina P. Rindova, Meenal Banga, Luis L. Martins

DOI: [10.1002/sej.70035](https://doi.org/10.1002/sej.70035)

Published: 2026-06-15

Keywords: entrepreneurial framing, entrepreneurial imagination, fiction, fictional framing, future making, legitimating novelty, possibilistic thinking, radical novelty

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Entrepreneurship, Strategic Management, Innovation Management
- **Theories:** Legitimacy Theory, Entrepreneurial Framing, Narratology, Possibilistic Thinking

Abstract:

Research Summary: The importance of entrepreneurial framing for legitimating novelty is well established, but the distinct challenges of legitimating radical novelty have received less attention. We articulate these challenges and propose fictional framing—the strategic and imaginative construction of a narrative world that blends the real and the imaginary using the practices of fictionalizing—as a means for addressing them. Drawing on literary theory, narratology, and the psychology of fiction, we theorize how fictional framing can engage stakeholders in co-imagining through specific imaginative impacts. We further theorize how stakeholder co-imagining fosters possibilistic thinking, changing their evaluative logic from focusing on likelihood and fit to what could be possible. Our framework extends the entrepreneurial framing toolkit by theorizing the distinct mechanisms for legitimating radical novelty through fictional framing. Managerial Summary: When entrepreneurs pursue radically novel ventures, from space habitation to de-extinction, conventional framing strategies that emphasize fit with existing knowledge and market categories are often ineffective. We propose that entrepreneurs can instead use fictional framing—the strategic and imaginative construction of a narrative world that blends the real and imaginary using fictionalizing practices. Unlike hype, which inflates expectations, fictional framing invites stakeholders to co-imagine possibilities and evaluate radically novel projects based on their transformative potential rather than their probability of success. Leveraging the power of fiction to transport, support mental simulation, and prompt audiences to envision themselves acting within the imagined world, we propose how entrepreneurs can turn stakeholders into co-explorers of the imaginary—active participants in co-imagining and co-creating consequential futures. **KEYWORDS** entrepreneurial framing, entrepreneurial imagination, fiction, fictional framing, future making, legitimating novelty, possibilistic thinking, radical novelty 1 |

□ Rindova - Co-explorers of the imaginary How fictional framing legitimates radical novelty.pdf

General Management

Journal of Management Studies

1. Property Rights and Corporate Toxic Emissions: Evidence from the Enactment of Property Law in China

Authors: Lihan Chen, Shaojie Lai, Xiaoling Pu, Qing Sophie Wang

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70127](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70127)

Published: 2026-06-28

Keywords: environmental performance, green innovation, institutional conditions, property rights, toxic emissions

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Governance, Environmental Management
- **Theories:** Property Rights Theory, Institutional Theory, Monitoring and Financing Mechanisms

Abstract:

Abstract

Property rights theory holds that stronger ownership protection stimulates firm investment, yet whether such investment supports environmentally beneficial uses remains unclear. We develop a property rights perspective on corporate pollution control, arguing that stronger ownership protection promotes cleaner production when complementary institutional conditions make environmental upgrading both strategically valuable and financially feasible. Exploiting China's 2007 Property Law as a quasi-natural experiment, we find that firms more exposed to the reform significantly reduce toxic emissions after the Law. Importantly, this emission-reducing effect is concentrated among firms operating under stronger external monitoring and among financially constrained firms that experience improved credit access. Mechanism tests show that green innovation and abatement upgrading partially explain the emission reductions. These findings extend property rights theory by showing that ownership protection does not automatically lead to cleaner production; its sustainability effects depend on monitoring and financing conditions that shape firms' strategic investment choices.

□ Chen - Property Rights and Corporate Toxic Emissions Evidence from the Enactment of Pro.pdf

2. Property Rights and Intangible Assets: Indigenous Theory and the Case of Indian Imagery

Authors: Terry R. Adler, Thomas G. Pittz, Carma M. Claw

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70125](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70125)

Published: 2026-06-28

Keywords: Indian imagery, Indigenous theory, institutional bricolage, intangible assets, organizational sociology, property rights, tribal sovereignty

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Sociology, International Business, Intellectual Property
- **Theories:** Property Rights Theory, Indigenous Theory, Organizational Sociology, Relational Inalienability

Abstract:

Abstract This paper develops a theory-building argument about the limits of property rights theory (PRT) when applied to culturally embedded intangible assets. Integrating property rights theory, organizational sociology, and Indigenous theory, we examine historically informed contrasts between low and moderate tribal sovereignty to show why tangible and intangible assets differ analytically in their governability. We argue that Native imagery reveals a class of contexts in which the specificity assumed by classical PRT becomes difficult to satisfy because authority is plural, asset boundaries are ambiguous, and value is relational rather than fully alienable. Using Native imagery as an illustrative case, we specify how PRT can be extended to better account for culturally embedded intangible assets by incorporating collective guardianship, community consent, sacred and relational inalienability constraints, and multi-sovereign enforcement. In doing so, the paper reframes property governance in settings where meaning, spirituality, and community relationships are integral to the asset itself.

□ Adler - Property Rights and Intangible Assets Indigenous Theory and the Case of Indian I.pdf

3. Government Orchestration at Play: The Influence of Disclosure Regulation on Stakeholder Accusations and the Role of CSR

Authors: Julia Bartosch, Emma Avetisyan, Philipp A. Thompson

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70130](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70130)

Published: 2026-06-26

Keywords: CSR, CSR regulation, CSR reporting, disclosure regulation, government orchestration, government-business interaction, non-financial disclosure, stakeholder accusations

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Non-market Strategy, Corporate Governance
- **Theories:** Stakeholder Theory, Institutional Theory, Government Orchestration, Social Evaluation

Abstract:

Abstract Government orchestration describes regulatory settings in which governments delegate some governance functions to private actors; for instance, business conduct is monitored by stakeholders under CSR disclosure regulation. This article examines the impact of this type of regulation on stakeholder monitoring, which is a core yet little-examined governance function. We analyse the effects of the European Union's Non-Financial Reporting Directive (NFRD) on stakeholder accusations and on the relationship between CSR and accusations across firms in 28 OECD countries (2007–2018) using a difference-in-differences design. The analysis shows that government orchestration significantly increases the number of stakeholder accusations by inducing a transparency dynamic. It also demonstrates a fundamental shift in how reported CSR relates to stakeholder accusations. In the past, companies were able to protect themselves from accusations by publicly reporting their CSR efforts. More recently, two patterns have emerged: where no disclosure regulation exists, CSR no longer buffers firms against accusations; under regulation, it produces a 'backfire effect' whereby CSR increases accusations. These findings advance research on the government–CSR nexus and social evaluations and offer a contextual explanation for previously inconsistent results on the link between CSR and stakeholder accusations.

□ Bartosch - Government Orchestration at Play The Influence of Disclosure Regulation on Stake.pdf

4. The Portfolio Ceiling in Asymmetric Alliances: Large Partners and the Internationalization of Japanese SMEs

Authors: Tianyou Hu, Andrew Delios

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70129](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70129)

Published: 2026-06-24

Keywords: alliance portfolios, asymmetric alliances, internationalization, interpartner competition, Japanese trading companies, SMEs

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, International Business, Entrepreneurship, Alliance Management
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Transaction Cost Economics, Alliance Portfolio Theory, Network Theory

Abstract:

Abstract Large partners are critical for small- and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) seeking to overcome resource constraints in internationalization. However, as an SME's portfolio of size-asymmetric alliances expands, governance costs can increase during post-formation alliance management. We develop theory on the resource benefits and governance costs of asymmetric alliance portfolios, arguing that the net benefit of access to large partners' resources is bounded by a portfolio ceiling. Initial alliances with large partners provide knowledge, legitimacy and network support that facilitate foreign direct investment (FDI) entries. As the portfolio expands, however, cross-partner interfaces, safeguarding demands and partner competition consume scarce managerial capacity, limiting SMEs' ability to mobilize large partners' resources. Using a

30-year firm-year panel (1990–2019) of Japanese SME trading companies and their equity alliances with business-group-affiliated general trading companies, we identify an inverted U-shaped relationship between the number of large partners and FDI entries, consistent with this portfolio ceiling. In line with our theory, competition among large partners is negatively associated with FDI entries. Overall, our study shows that, for resource-constrained firms, the net value of asymmetric alliance portfolios depends on the balance between partner resource benefits and portfolio-level governance costs.

□ Hu - The Portfolio Ceiling in Asymmetric Alliances Large Partners and the Internation.pdf

5. Middle Managers' Interface Work: Exploring Micro-Practices for Co-Adoption of Emerging Ecosystem Value Propositions

Authors: Krithika Randhawa, Wim Vanhaverbeke, Mariano L. M. Heyden, Paavo Ritala

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70124](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70124)

Published: 2026-06-23

Keywords: co-adoption, ecosystems, interfaces, middle managers, strategic leadership

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Organizational Behavior, Strategic Leadership
- **Theories:** Social-Symbolic Work, Micro-foundations of Strategy, Middle Management Perspective, Interface Work

Abstract:

Abstract Emerging ecosystem value propositions require collective co-adoption by heterogeneous stakeholders. Focusing on middle managers (MMs) in ecosystem emergence, we introduce the notion of MM interface work: a form of social-symbolic work comprising discursive, relational, and material micro-practices within and across cognitive, behavioural, regulatory, and political interfaces. Drawing on rich primary and secondary data collected over 5 years from six technology providers in the healthcare sector, we explain how these micro-practices underpin the co-adoption of an emerging ecosystem value proposition. Two key mechanisms drive this process: the integration of micro-practices within each interface and the synergistic alignment of the micro-practices across interfaces. Our study advances ecosystem and strategic leadership literatures by explaining how MMs may influence co-adoption of an emerging ecosystem value proposition 'from the middle-out' .

□ Randhawa - Middle Managers' Interface Work Exploring Micro-Practices for Co-Adoption of Eme.pdf

6. Chasing –Or Escaping –The Limelight of Sustainability Media Attention? Narcissism's Opposing Effects for Women and Men CEOs on Environmental Performance

Authors: Jamie L. Gloor, Sana Chiu, Judith Walls, Giannina Faktor

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70104](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70104)

Published: 2026-06-14

Keywords: CEO, environmental performance, gender, measurement, narcissism, sustainability

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Upper Echelons, Environmental Strategy
- **Theories:** Upper Echelons Theory, Behavioral Theory of the Firm, Gender Role Congruity Theory, Social Evaluation

Abstract:

Abstract

According to strategy research, firms with more narcissistic CEOs and firms with women CEOs exhibit better environmental performance (EP); however, we propose that better EP is unexpected when jointly considering these characteristics. Although positive attention theoretically drives more narcissistic CEOs' EP, by considering the gendered factors influencing CEO cognition and behaviour, we propose that this effect reverses for women. We develop and validate a novel, earnings-call-based machine learning measure of CEO narcissism (which we also compare with existing measures by Chatterjee and Hambrick 2011, *Administrative Science Quarterly*, 56, 202–207 and Petrenko et al. 2016, *Strategic Management Journal*, 37, 262–79) to test how CEO sex, narcissism, and positive attention shape EP. We triangulate evidence supporting our hypotheses from S&P 1500 firm panel data (Study 1) and an experiment with strategic leaders (Study 2): when EP generates more positive media attention, more narcissism negatively (positively) affects EP with women (men) leaders. Advancing a more precise understanding of how CEO narcissism affects EP for men and women CEOs, we explain the mixed effects of CEO narcissism and CEO sex in separately developing literatures; we also contribute to the microfoundations of (environmental) strategy with important implications for scholarship and practice while also mitigating measurement constraints in understanding the relations between CEO narcissism and firm action.

□ Gloor - Chasing –Or Escaping –The Limelight of Sustainability Media Attention Narcissism.pdf

7. Moralized Identities in and Around Organizations: An Identity Work Perspective

Authors: Michael J. Gill, Andrew D. Brown

DOI: [10.1111/joms.70120](https://doi.org/10.1111/joms.70120)

Published: 2026-06-14

Keywords: identity, identity work, identity work perspective, moral identity, moralized identity

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Organizational Behavior, Business Ethics
- **Theories:** Identity Work Perspective, Social Identity Theory, Moral Identity, Power Relations

Abstract:

Abstract

In this article, we examine the literature on moralized identities –the range of identities that people construct for themselves that are underpinned by issues of morality. We problematize traditional theorizing by drawing on the identity work perspective to provide an explanatory framework that diverts attention away from a focus on what single, stable, unified, and rarely fully contextualized moralized identities do to theorize how multiple, fluid, context-specific, moralized identities embedded in relations of power develop. Our framework outlines a dynamic conceptualization of moralized identities which disrupts the assumption of moral coherence by theorizing moralized identities as plural, dynamic, relational, and networked. Building on our framework, we provide an agenda for future moralized identities research.

□ Gill - Moralized Identities in and Around Organizations An Identity Work Perspective.pdf

Journal of Management

1. Crises Unbound: Institutions, Occupational Groups, and the Construction of Omnicrises

Authors: Gerardo Patriotta, Maxim Voronov

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261448817](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261448817)

Published: 2026-06-15

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Theory, Crisis Management, Sociology of Occupations, Institutional Theory
- **Theories:** Institutional Theory, Sociology of Occupations, Jurisdictional Theory, Institutional Repair

Abstract:

Omnicrises are systemic disruptions that transcend organizational boundaries, rapidly escalating across institutional domains and destabilizing the jurisdictional order through which social life is coordinated. Unlike conventional crises that are confined to specific organizations or industries, an omnicrisis triggers a state of jurisdictional fracturing, creating vacuums of authority that undermine communities' sense of stability and continuity. We argue that omnicrises occur when systemic disruptions misalign established connections between occupational mandates, settled jurisdictions, and recognized expertise, compelling occupational groups to avow, delegate, or realign authority in response to unfolding threats. Resolution emerges through processes of institutional repair that stabilize a coherent jurisdictional settlement and enable the construction of a "new normal." By incorporating insights from institutional theory and the sociology of occupations, we advance understanding of crisis governance, expertise under systemic threat, and the reconstruction of institutional order in an era of pervasive uncertainty.

□Patriotta - Crises Unbound Institutions, Occupational Groups, and the Construction of Omnicr.pdf

2. "All Hands on Deck" or "Hands off the Tiller" ? Linking Understaffing and Organizational Citizenship Behaviors

Authors: Winny Shen, Shani Pindek, Jiawei Zheng, Jie Zhong, James W. Beck

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261453875](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261453875)

Published: 2026-06-16

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Social Exchange Theory, Attribution Theory, Conservation of Resources Theory

Abstract:

In this paper, we seek to clarify competing perspectives on the relationship between workplace staffing conditions and organizational citizenship behaviors (OCBs). On one hand, workers may engage in more OCBs in the face of understaffing, reflecting a greater inclination to help during their organizations' time of need. On the other hand, workers may engage in fewer OCBs due to understaffing, reflecting a withdrawal of effort under stressful circumstances to protect and conserve resources. Integrating social exchange principles with research on human resource (HR) attributions, we examine these two possibilities and their underlying mechanisms and boundary conditions across three multi-wave survey studies. We find some support for both perspectives. That is, manpower understaffing can prompt OCBs via greater felt challenge, whereas expertise understaffing can subvert OCBs via lower felt obligation to the organization but can also promote OCBs via greater felt obligation to one's coworkers. Additionally, expertise understaffing can either enhance or diminish feelings of challenge, leading to downstream effects on OCBs, depending upon circumstances. Finally, relations between understaffing and proposed mediators varied based on perceived chronicity of staffing conditions and attributions regarding the degree to which staffing conditions were due to factors external to the organization (e.g., the COVID-19 pandemic), respectively. Implications of our results for theory and practice are discussed.

□ Shen - "All Hands on Deck" or "Hands off the Tiller" Linking Understaffing and Organiza.pdf

3. Leveraging the Reputation of Being Socially Responsible: Evidence from Firms' Online Job Postings

Authors: Qiang (John) Li, Bingyi Qin, Wenfeng Wang, Zheng Wang

DOI: [10.1177/01492063261448457](https://doi.org/10.1177/01492063261448457)

Published: 2026-06-18

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Corporate Social Responsibility, Human Resource Management
- **Theories:** Resource-Based View, Signaling Theory

Abstract:

While prior research has examined individuals' preference to work for socially responsible employers, little is known about how firms actively leverage their CSR reputation in recruiting talent. Drawing on the resource-based view (RBV), we conceptualize CSR reputation as a strategic resource that provides firms with a competitive edge in the labor market. To leverage this strategic resource, firms set higher skill requirements and advertise their CSR activities in job postings, which allows them to more effectively target and recruit talent. Using a large sample of online job posting data, we first provide empirical evidence confirming that CSR reputation is positively associated with higher skill requirements in terms of education, experience, and social and cognitive skills, as well as greater promotion of CSR activities in job postings. Using Acknowledgments: We would like to thank Action Editor Hermann Ndofor and two anonymous reviewers for their guidance and constructive feedback in the development of this manuscript. We also thank Heli Wang and Wei Shi for their helpful suggestions on earlier versions of this article. We acknowledge the helpful comments we received at the 84th Academy of Management Annual Conference and from the seminar participants at CEIBS, HKUST (Guangzhou), and the University of Hong Kong. This research was supported in part by a research fund from CEIBS (AG25CSR) and by the Scientific Foundation for Youth Scholars of Shenzhen University. Wenfeng Wang gratefully acknowledges the research support provided by the Southern University of Science and Technology. All authors contributed equally. Supplemental material for this article is available with the manuscript on the JOM website. Corresponding author: Qiang (John) Li, China Europe International Business School (CEIBS), 699 Hongfeng Road, Pudong, Shanghai, 201206, China.

□ Li - Leveraging the Reputation of Being Socially Responsible Evidence from Firms' Onl.pdf

Academy of Management Annals

1. Behind the Wall: An Integrative Review of Defensiveness at Work

Authors: Jeffrey Yip, Dayna O. H. Walker

DOI: [10.5465/annals.2023.0213](https://doi.org/10.5465/annals.2023.0213)

Published: 2026-06-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Organizational Behavior, Organizational Theory, Psychology
- **Theories:** Psychodynamic Theory, Social Cognitive Theory, Defensive Routines, Behavioral Theory

Abstract:

Defensiveness is a pervasive challenge in organizational life. It emerges when leaders resist feedback, when teams deflect accountability, and when organizations develop routines that insulate them from change. Yet, research on defensiveness is fragmented, with four different perspectives that have developed in parallel: (1) psychodynamic research on defense mechanisms, (2) social cognitive studies on defensive reasoning, (3) behavioral research on observable defenses, and (4) organizational research on defensive routines and social defenses. In this integrative review of 523 peer-reviewed articles, we synthesize findings across the four perspectives to address the following questions: What is defensiveness? What triggers defensiveness? How does defensiveness unfold in organizations? What are effective ways to manage defensiveness? Across perspectives, we uncover a core paradox: defensiveness may offer short-term relief to individuals, but it creates dysfunction in the systems it aims to protect. Understanding this paradox is key to managing defensiveness and interrupting reinforcing defensive cycles in organizations.

□ Yip - Behind the Wall An Integrative Review of Defensiveness at Work.pdf

2. Topics Worth Reviewing, and Why You Should Review Them

Authors: Matthew A. Cronin, Elizabeth George

DOI: [10.5465/annals.2026.0175](https://doi.org/10.5465/annals.2026.0175)

Published: 2026-06-25

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Organizational Theory, Research Methodology, Knowledge Management
- **Theories:** Theory Development, Philosophy of Science, Knowledge Synthesis, Scholarly Impact

Abstract:

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□ Cronin - Topics Worth Reviewing, and Why You Should Review Them.pdf

Strategy

Organization Science

1. Technology (Non)Emergence: How System Interdependencies Among Activities by Heterogeneous Actors Shaped Alternative Solar Technology Trajectories

Authors: Mara Guerra, Rajshree Agarwal

DOI: [10.1287/orsc.2022.17185](https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2022.17185)

Published: 2026-06-23

Fields & Theories:

- **Fields:** Strategic Management, Innovation Ecosystems, Technology Management
- **Theories:** Systems Theory, Dominant Design, Ecosystem Theory

Abstract:

We examine industry and technology (non)emergence by integrating actor-centric and systems perspective literature streams. We use historical methods to analyze rich data tracking investments by actors spanning private, public, and academic sectors in the solar photovoltaics context. The industry took several decades after commercialization to emerge; moreover, silicon and thin film technologies experienced divergent fates despite firm takeoff. By uncovering critical interdependencies across activities by different actors, we show that, whereas attention by all actors to developing various elements of technological systems is necessary for emergence, it may not be sufficient. The industry emerged after activities by technology producers, industry associations, and government agencies ensured stable institutional support that stimulated latent demand (by utilities and end consumers) and created reinforcing loops among activities by technology producers and research institutes for solar technologies to become a viable alternative to fossil fuels. Moreover, silicon experienced additional reinforcing loops in demand-side and supply-side ecosystems, wherein technology producers and equipment manufacturers leveraged adjacent mature supply chains to meet demand-side scale and reliability requirements in fast growing markets. In contrast, thin film experienced balancing loops wherein nascent firm-specific supply side alliances could not address these demand side needs. These findings showcase how dominant designs may emerge even when there is no ex ante competitive dynamics among technology producers: Although silicon may have benefited from first mover advantage at the technology level, our study highlights that ecosystem first mover advantages of silicon relative to thin film were particularly salient in their divergent fates. Open Access Statement: This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License. You are free to copy, distribute, transmit and adapt this work, but you must attribute this work as "Organization Science. Copyright © 2026 The Author(s). <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2022.17185>, used under a Creative Commons Attribution License: <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>." Supplemental Material: The online appendices are available at <https://doi.org/10.1287/orsc.2022.17185>.

□ Guerra - Technology (Non)Emergence How System Interdependencies Among Activities by Heter.pdf
